

Binary Sunset MP4 Wallpaper Setup

Pop!_OS 24.04 + COSMIC/Wayland + mpvpaper

Goal:

- Use `/usr/share/binary_sunset.mp4` as the desktop wallpaper
 - Play the video's audio
 - Loop forever
 - Run independently of any terminal
 - Start automatically whenever the graphical user session starts
 - Restart automatically if `mpvpaper` crashes
 - Be easy to shut off instantly before interviews, meetings, or calls
-

1. Update Pop!_OS

```
sudo apt update
```

2. Install mpvpaper build dependencies

```
sudo apt install git meson ninja-build libmpv-dev mpv
```

3. Download mpvpaper

```
cd ~  
git clone --single-branch https://github.com/GhostNaN/mpvpaper
```

4. Enter the mpvpaper folder

```
cd ~/mpvpaper
```

5. Configure the build

```
meson setup build --prefix=/usr/local
```

6. Build mpvpaper

```
ninja -C build
```

7. Install mpvpaper

```
sudo ninja -C build install
```

The executable should now exist here:

```
/usr/local/bin/mpvpaper
```

8. Verify mpvpaper installation

```
mpvpaper --help
```

If the help page appears, mpvpaper is installed correctly.

9. Place the wallpaper video in /usr/share

Assuming `binary_sunset.mp4` is currently in Downloads:

```
sudo cp ~/Downloads/binary_sunset.mp4 /usr/share/binary_sunset.mp4
```

Verify:

```
ls -lh /usr/share/binary_sunset.mp4
```

10. Test the wallpaper manually

Run:

```
mpvpaper -o "loop-file=inf --audio=yes --hwdec=auto" ALL "/usr/share/  
binary_sunset.mp4"
```

Expected result:

- Binary Sunset becomes the wallpaper
- Video plays
- Audio plays
- Video loops forever

Press:

```
Ctrl + C
```

after confirming that it works.

11. Create the systemd user-service directory

```
mkdir -p ~/.config/systemd/user
```

12. Create the mpvpaper service

```
nano ~/.config/systemd/user/mpvpaper.service
```

Paste exactly:

```
[Unit]  
Description=MPV Binary Sunset Video Wallpaper
```

```
After=graphical-session.target

[Service]
ExecStart=/usr/local/bin/mpvpaper -o "loop-file=inf --audio=yes --hwdec=auto"
ALL /usr/share/binary_sunset.mp4
Restart=always
RestartSec=2

[Install]
WantedBy=default.target
```

Save:

```
Ctrl + O
Enter
```

Exit Nano:

```
Ctrl + X
```

13. Reload the systemd user configuration

```
systemctl --user daemon-reload
```

No output is normal.

14. Enable automatic startup

```
systemctl --user enable mpvpaper.service
```

Expected output should resemble:

```
Created symlink ... default.target.wants/mpvpaper.service → ... mpvpaper.service
```

15. Start the wallpaper service now

```
systemctl --user start mpvpaper.service
```

The video wallpaper and music should now start.

The terminal is NOT required to remain open.

16. Verify that the service is running

```
systemctl --user status mpvpaper.service
```

Look for:

```
Active: active (running)
```

Press:

```
q
```

to leave the status screen.

17. Test terminal independence

Close the terminal completely.

The wallpaper and audio should continue playing.

If they continue playing, systemd is controlling mpvpaper correctly.

18. Reboot test

```
sudo reboot
```

After logging back into Pop!_OS:

```
COSMIC / Wayland starts
    ↓
systemd --user starts
    ↓
mpvpaper.service starts
    ↓
/usr/share/binary_sunset.mp4 loads
    ↓
video loops forever
    ↓
audio plays
```

No terminal needs to be opened.

Interview / Meeting Emergency Controls

If the wallpaper music needs to be shut down immediately before an interview, meeting, Discord call, Zoom call, etc.:

```
systemctl --user stop mpvpaper.service
```

This immediately stops:

- Video wallpaper
- Wallpaper audio
- mpvpaper process

It does NOT disable autostart permanently.

To bring the wallpaper back:

```
systemctl --user start mpvpaper.service
```

Optional Short Commands

Instead of typing the full systemctl commands every time, create short commands.

Open:

```
nano ~/.bashrc
```

Add these lines at the bottom:

```
alias walloff='systemctl --user stop mpvpaper.service'  
alias wallon='systemctl --user start mpvpaper.service'  
alias wallrestart='systemctl --user restart mpvpaper.service'  
alias wallstatus='systemctl --user status mpvpaper.service'
```

Save:

```
Ctrl + O  
Enter  
Ctrl + X
```

Reload Bash:

```
source ~/.bashrc
```

Now the commands become:

Before interview

```
walloff
```

After interview

```
wallon
```

Restart wallpaper

```
wallrestart
```

Check wallpaper status

```
wallstatus
```

Useful Management Commands

Stop wallpaper

```
systemctl --user stop mpvpaper.service
```

Start wallpaper

```
systemctl --user start mpvpaper.service
```

Restart wallpaper

```
systemctl --user restart mpvpaper.service
```

Check status

```
systemctl --user status mpvpaper.service
```

Disable automatic startup permanently

```
systemctl --user disable mpvpaper.service
```

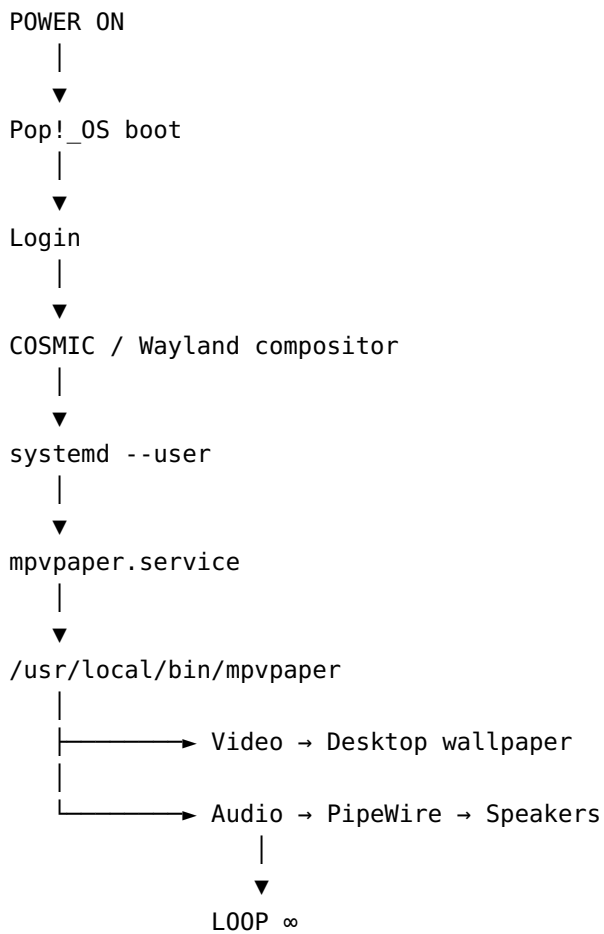
Re-enable automatic startup

```
systemctl --user enable mpvpaper.service
```

View errors/logs

```
journalctl --user -u mpvpaper.service -b
```

Final Architecture



Important:

`mpvpaper` starts when the graphical user session becomes available, not before the login screen, because it requires the Wayland compositor.

Wallpaper file:

```
/usr/share/binary_sunset.mp4
```

mpvpaper executable:

```
/usr/local/bin/mpvpaper
```

systemd service:

```
~/.config/systemd/user/mpvpaper.service
```

Emergency interview controls:

```
walloff  
wallon
```

Result:

Binary Sunset during normal life. Silence during interviews. Civilization preserved. 🌅🎵😓